

Briefing for Skype Call between Rev. Prof. Fr Ioan Sauca, Interim General Secretary of the World Council of Churches, and Dr Abuzar Ebrahimi Torkaman ('Dr Ebrahimi'), Head of the Islamic Culture and Relations Organisation, Tehran, and others

Skype Call to happen in Fr Ioan's office at 1100 Geneva time, Tuesday 27 October 2020. (1330 in Tehran)

Carla Khijoyan will be present at the meeting. I believe she was part of the WCC delegation in the past so you probably have met her.

Practical Information

WCC skype address: TO BE SUPPLIED

CID skype address: interreligiousdc@gmail.com – please confirm

If skype breaks down, the greetings can be given by phone.

WCC phone numbers:

Fr Ioan's PA (Diana Chabloz) +41 22 7916285 or her mobile +41 79 1020216

Fr Ioan's desk +41 22 916284

Carla Khijoyan mobile +41 792 990 379

CID numbers: Zahra mobile: 00989121077525; Ali mobile 00 98 919 603 2202

Present on the Iranian Side

- Dr Abuzar Ebrahimi Torkaman (Address him as 'Dr Ebrahimi'), Head of the Islamic Culture and Relations Organisation (ICRO), Tehran. He is the senior figure present on their side. ICRO (of which he is the Head) is the umbrella government organisation to which CID belongs
- Dr Mohammad Mahdi Tashkiri (Address him as 'Dr Tashkiri'), Director General of the Center for Interreligious and Intercultural Dialogue (CID), Tehran. His elder brother, Ayatollah Sheikh Mohammad Ali Tashkiri, who had been involved in the dialogue, died in August.
- Dr Rasoul Rasoulipour, former Director General of CID, so has taken part in the dialogues in the past

Zarah: please supply further information (a brief 'bio') on each of these for me to share with Fr Ioan before the call.

Do we know if Archbishop Sarkissian is taking part?

Running Order *(to be confirmed after I speak to Zahra/CID on Saturday)*

How do we wish to start? As WCC was going to host the meeting in September, shall we open the comments? This is what I suggest below, but we can discuss.

- Carla opens the meeting and introduces Fr Ioan
- Fr Ioan gives his formal message of greeting
- *Should Fr Ioan then invite Dr Ebrahimi to speak? Or maybe Dr Tashkiri might then introduce Dr Ebrahimi – to be determined.*
- Dr Ebrahimi gives his formal greeting. *We are awaiting the English version of this.*
- *If Archbishop Sarkissian attends, he can at this point be invited to say some words.*
- Fr Ioan and Dr Ebrahimi then both sign a copy of the certificate. *A photo of Fr Ioan signing should be taken at this point.*
- Any other conversation that might happen at this point. *I will mention to Fr Ioan that a natural subject to raise is our document ‘Serving a Wounded World in Interreligious Solidarity’ which CID has translated into Persian, and Dr Tashkiri has written a response to it (which was due to be given in the staff meeting which was going to follow this formal meeting, but has had to be postponed).*
- *Are there any other matters you expect Dr Ebrahimi to mention?*
- Conclude meeting when appropriate. 30 minutes was scheduled.

Other questions

- We are awaiting an English translation of the message to be delivered by Dr Ebrahimi.
- The PA to Fr Sauca asks if we can possibly exchange electronic signatures of Fr Sauca and Dr Ebrahimi. This will make it much easier to prepare the certificates before sending them out. Otherwise they will have to be mailed to and from Iran and Switzerland and this may take some time and be a little unreliable. We would of course destroy the electronic signature of Dr Ebrahimi immediately after using it for the certificates.